

▲ **DREYSE NEEDLE-FIRE RIFLE MODEL 1862**

Date 1868

Origin Germany

Barrel 32in (81.2cm)

Caliber 15.43mm

Prussia adopted Dreyse's revolutionary bolt-action design (see pp.108–09) into its military service in 1848. Soon, different models began to be built, each one for a different branch within the army, such as line infantry or cavalry. The Model 1862 was an infantry rifle first manufactured in 1862, but this particular piece was built in 1868.



Front sling swivel

Barrel band

Foresight



FULL VIEW

Rear sight

▼ **PEABODY-MARTINI RIFLE**

Date c.1870

Origin US

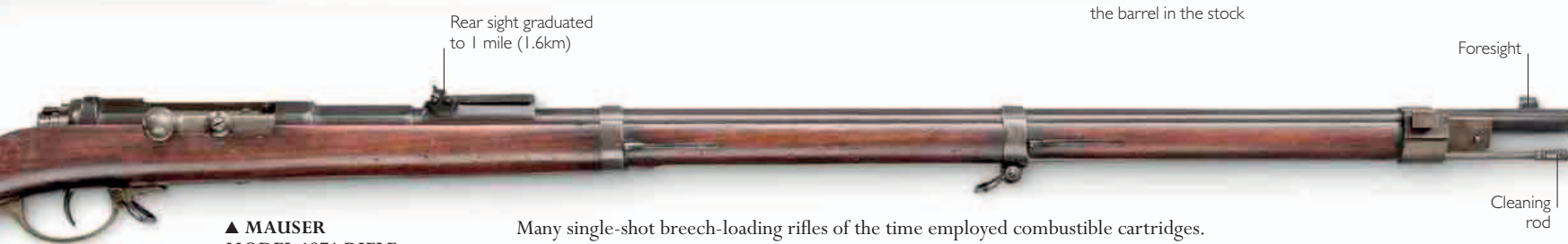
Barrel 30in (76cm)

Caliber .45in

This lever-action military rifle was designed by Henry O. Peabody and produced by the Providence Tool Company of Providence, Rhode Island. It is equipped with a safety catch. Many units were bought by the government of Turkey for the Russo–Turkish War (1877–78).



Barrel band anchors the barrel in the stock



Rear sight graduated to 1 mile (1.6km)

Foresight

Cleaning rod

▲ **MAUSER MODEL 1871 RIFLE**

Date 1872 onward

Origin Germany

Barrel 32½in (83cm)

Caliber 11 × 60mm

Many single-shot breech-loading rifles of the time employed combustible cartridges. German manufacturer Waffenfabrik Mauser began modifying Dreyse guns, such as the Model 1862 (above), to accept brass cartridges, but Peter Paul Mauser produced a new design with a bolt-action breech mechanism stronger than that of the Dreyse rifle. It was modified to take metallic cartridges (see pp.112–13) rather than fully combustible paper ones, and could therefore fire more powerful ammunition (cartridges with a larger powder charge). Effective out to a range of 875 yards (800m), the *Infanteriegewehr* (infantry rifle) M71 established Mauser's preeminence among suppliers of military rifles.



Front sling swivel

▲ **SPRINGFIELD MODEL 1866 RIFLE ALLIN "TRAPDOOR" CONVERSION**

Date 1874

Origin US

Barrel 32½in (83cm)

Caliber .45in

The perfection of the unitary cartridge left the world's armies with a dilemma: what should they do with their millions of redundant muzzle-loaders? The US Army modified its rifled muskets by milling out the top of the barrel, creating a chamber for the cartridge, and installing a front-hinged breech cover, or "trapdoor," incorporating a firing pin.